🗂️ ORGANIZE THE MESS · PROJECT 4 · CODE YOU NEVER WRITE

The photos I forgot I had

Perceptual-hash fingerprinting to find duplicate & near-duplicate photos — a dry run, originals untouched.

✓ Backed up first | ✓ Read-only on originals | ✓ Dry run — nothing deleted

2 groups
of matching photos

4 copies
redundant, could delete

129 KB
reclaimable safely

WHAT THE FINGERPRINT FOUND

Group 1 — city street

2 matching images

KEEP	DSC00891.png	1400×1400 · 11.1 KB
DELETE	IMG-20250903-WA0007.jpg	1050×1050 · 42.8 KB

A WhatsApp-recompressed copy — not byte-identical, but the same picture.

Group 2 — beach sunset

4 matching images

KEEP	IMG_2043.jpg	1600×1200 · 92.3 KB
DELETE	beach_sunset_edited.jpg	1600×1200 · 54.4 KB
DELETE	IMG_2043-copy.jpg	800×600 · 28.0 KB
DELETE	thumb_2043.jpg	160×120 · 3.8 KB ⚑ thumbnail

SKIPPED (NOT DELETED, JUST NOTED)

broken.jpg — unreadable / corrupt. · **notes.txt** — not an image file.

Found **4 redundant copies** across 2 photo groups, **129 KB** reclaimable. This is a **plan, not an action** — the largest copy is kept in each group, the thumbnail is flagged, and nothing is deleted until I approve.

Fingerprinted every image with a perceptual hash (pHash), grouped matches within a 5-bit distance, kept the largest per group, skipped corrupt/non-image files. Backup-first, read-only, dry-run. Verified: reclaimable KB matches the sum of deletable files by hand.